

Surrealistic collage essay

After reading Introduction to Generative AI, published by Shelter Island, required by this course, I am still astonished by how advanced natural language processing (NLP) and large language models (LLMs) such as ChatGPT and Claude have become. Before I learned about machine learning and transformers, their answers seemed even more mysterious because they sounded so human. I now understand that these systems do not have feelings, consciousness, or human reasoning. Still, their conversational style can make people feel understood and may lead users to imagine that a model can truly think or care.

Generative AI is developing extremely quickly. It can produce text, images, music, voices, and video. However, from the book I learned that at the same time, these systems consume substantial energy and raise concerns about bias, copyright, and the future of creative work. Although developers try to reduce bias, models can still repeat patterns and stereotypes found in their training data. Human judgment remains essential.

The generative AI work that inspires me most is AI-generated short drama series I watched online. I have always considered films and literatures irreplaceable (because it's art/culture related works), so I was shocked that AI-generated video could support a complete visual story. It showed me that a written story could become a film with fewer production resources such as fewer producers, directors, actors, or lighting specialists, although people still write, prompt, select, edit, and guide the result. This kind of work inspires me because it may allow more writers who are less professional, maybe even amateurs, to present their imaginations in their head visually. It also leaves me thinking about authorship and artists' livelihoods. I see generative AI as a powerful creative tool, but one that should be used critically, transparently, and responsibly.